IMPOSSIBLE RENDEZ-VOUS N O . 1

Frida Kahlo & Ali Khamenei

In a surreal alternate reality, Frida Kahlo and Ali Khamenei found themselves sitting across from each other in a vibrant, otherworldly garden. The air was filled with a strange mix of Mexican and Persian scents, and the flowers seemed to bloom in hues never before seen. A peculiar fusion of cultures and times, their meeting was as impossible as the conversation that unfolded.

Drawing by Mobina Khalili

Frida Kahlo: (gesturing to her iconic unibrow) Senor Khamenei, I must say, your beard is quite remarkable. I've always been a fan of self-expression.

Ali Khamenei: (adjusting his turban) Gracias, Frida. Your artwork is intriguing, though I find your choice of colors rather bold.

Frida Kahlo: Well, life is bold, isn't it? Speaking of which, have you ever tried painting your world in vibrant shades of pain and passion?

Ali Khamenei: (raises an eyebrow) I lead a nation, Frida, not a canvas.

Frida Kahlo: (takes a sip from a teacup shaped like a paint palette) True, but a nation is like a canvas, and you hold the brush. What strokes will you make?

Ali Khamenei: (leaning back) My strokes are guided by principles and faith, not the whims of emotion.

Frida Kahlo: (smirking) Emotion is the essence of life. Without it, the canvas is empty, the garden barren. Tell me, do your principles bloom like flowers in the spring?

Ali Khamenei: (nods) They endure, like the roots of ancient trees.

Frida Kahlo: (laughs) Ah, roots. They anchor, but they can also trap. Be careful not to let them strangle the vibrant spirit of your people.

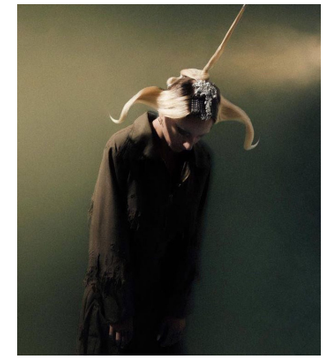
Ali Khamenei: (sternly) Order and discipline are the foundations of a strong nation.

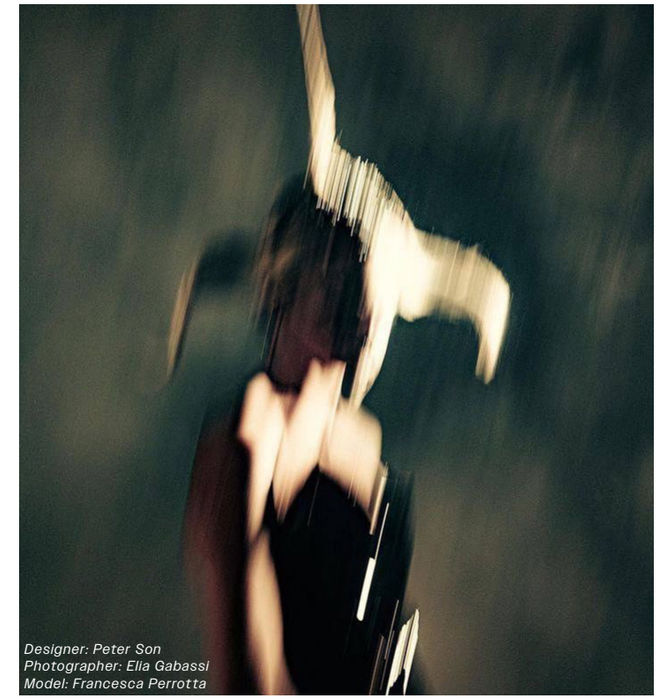
Frida Kahlo: (raises a paintbrush like a scepter) And passion, Senor Khamenei, is the heartbeat that gives it life.

Written by AI
Edited by Aleksandra Eremashvili

In a conversation, where a clash of words and ideologies, where art and politics collided in a surreal dance, the garden absorbed their words, as if the very essence of their discourse transformed the flowers into a living masterpiece, witnessing the intersection of two improbable souls in a conversation that could only exist in the realm of the impossible.

NAVIGATING AND UTOPIAN VISIONS REALITIES





Designer: Peter Son
Photographer: Elia Gabassi
Model: Francesca Perrotta

Within the dynamic realm of Russian fashion, a rich tapestry of contrasts unfolds, weaving together positive and negative consequences, historical influences, the significance of utopian visions, and the unexplored boundaries of menswear.

The Russian fashion landscape, as revealed in this narrative, stands as a double-edged sword. The absence of intense market competition has allowed small Russian brands to thrive, exemplified by the success of “All Around Us.” This brand, specializing in outdoor comfort wear, found fertile ground in the absence of direct European or Russian analogs. However, the downside emerges in the form of potential quality compromise due to the lack of market competition. The wellspring of creativity for this industry transcends mere aesthetics, delving into the historical and natural realms. With a keen eye for authenticity, Peter Son, an emerging fashion designer, draws inspiration from the darker chapters of Russian history, such as the Gulags and the industrial architecture of the communist era. These somber realities serve as a foundation for the creative process, adding depth to the narrative woven into each design. Amidst the challenges and triumphs, let’s emphasize the vital role of utopian visions in representing Russian reality. While acknowledging the necessity of addressing current issues, the infusion of utopian ideas becomes a beacon of hope. It serves as a reminder to both designers and consumers to dream of a brighter future, transcending the immediate challenges faced by contemporary Russia.

In the realm of menswear, we also delve into the complexities of breaking societal norms. Specifically, crafting menswear dresses becomes a delicate dance to make traditionally feminine garments exude masculine strength. The challenge lies not only in the design but in challenging societal perceptions, allowing men to feel strong and self-confident even in attire traditionally deemed exclusive to women. To illustrate, small brands such as Namilia should be applauded for